

SKINKS

Distributed worldwide, the Scincidae are a diverse group of 1,400 species. While many are active diurnal predators, several others are nocturnal, limbless, burrowing lizards. They use chemical as well as visual communication. Although typically oviparous, many species are viviparous.



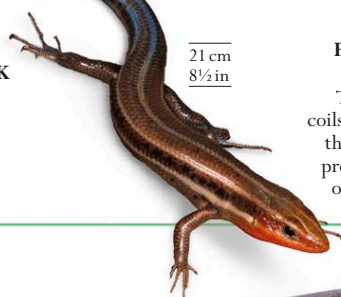
25 cm
10 in

EMERALD TREE SKINK

Lamprolepis smaragdina

Native to islands of the W. Pacific, this arboreal lizard preys on insects on bare tree trunks.

bright coloration
on flanks



21 cm
8½ in

FIVE-LINED SKINK

Plestiodon fasciatus

This N. American skink coils around its eggs to protect them during incubation. It prefers woodland and feeds on ground-living insects.



35 cm
14 in

FIRE SKINK

Mochlus fernandi

This insectivorous skink is native to humid, forested areas of W. Africa. Its attractive coloration makes it a popular lizard to keep in captivity.

weak legs

PERCIVAL'S LANCE SKINK

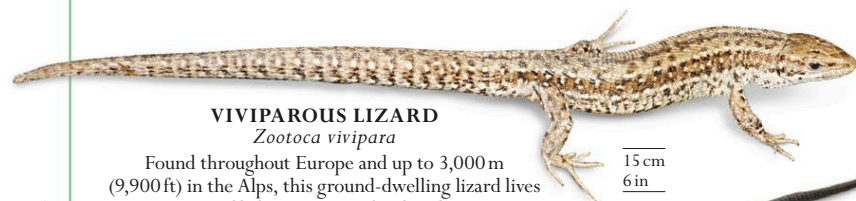
Acontias percivali

This legless African skink burrows through leaf litter to hunt its invertebrate prey. It gives birth to up to three live young.

30 cm
12 in

WALL AND SAND LIZARDS

Lizards of the family Lacertidae are found in a wide variety of habitats throughout the Old World. They are active predators and have complex social systems, with males defending their territory. Almost all species lay eggs. These lizards typically have a large head.



VIVIPAROUS LIZARD

Zootoca vivipara

Found throughout Europe and up to 3,000 m (9,900 ft) in the Alps, this ground-dwelling lizard lives in a variety of habitats. It gives birth to live young.

15 cm
6 in



LARGE PSAMMODROMUS

Psammodromus algirus

Found in the W. Mediterranean region, this small lizard inhabits dense, bushy areas. During breeding, males develop a red patch on their throat.

20 cm
8 in

7.5 cm
3 in

OCELLATED LIZARD

Timon lepidus

The largest European member of the family, this lizard lives in dry, bushy places. It eats insects, eggs, and small mammals.

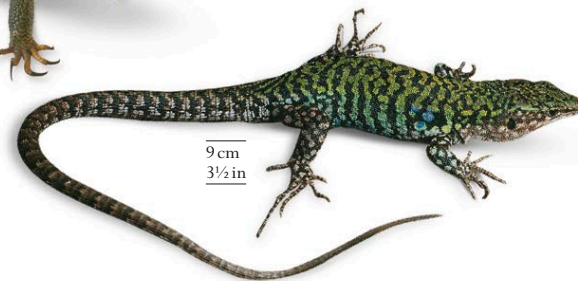


FRINGE-TOED LIZARD

Acanthodactylus erythrurus

Found in the Iberian Peninsula and N. Africa, this species has fringes of spiny scales on its toes that enable it to cross over loose sand.

7.5 cm
3 in



9 cm
3½ in

ITALIAN WALL LIZARD

Podarcis siculus

A ground-living species, found around the N. Mediterranean, this lizard inhabits grassy places and often lives in close proximity to humans.



GRAN CANARIA GIANT LIZARD

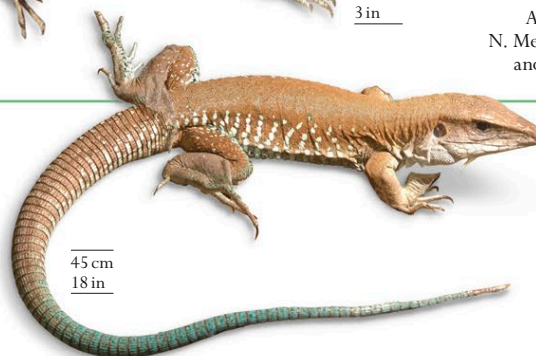
Gallotia stehlini

This large species is restricted to the shrubland of Grand Canary Island. It is diurnal and herbivorous.

80 cm
32 in

WHIPTAILS AND RACERUNNERS

These fast-running American lizards occupy a range of habitats. Smaller species of the Teiidae are insectivorous but larger ones are carnivorous. All 120 species are oviparous, although many whiptails are all-female and reproduce parthenogenetically, laying viable, fertile eggs without mating.



45 cm
18 in

AMAZON RACERUNNER

Ameiva ameiva

Powerful jaws allow this S. American species to feed on small vertebrates and insects that it catches in open terrestrial habitats.

long tail used
in defence

RED TEGU

Salvator rufescens

This large species of the arid regions in central S. America is an active predator and scavenger, but is also known to eat plants.

1.2 m
4 ft

